processing system is used to include the resource such as people procedures, and devices that are used to accomplish the processing of data for producing desirable output. Data processing is restructuring or recording of data to increase their usefulness and value for some particular purpose.

6.4. Objectives of Data Processing:

The following are the objectives of data processing:

1. To provide mass storage for relevant data.
2. To make easy access to the data for the user.
3. To provide prompt response to user requests for data.
4. To eliminate redundant data.
5. To allow multiple users to be active at one time.
6. To allow for growth in the data base system.
7. To protect the data from harms like physical and unauthorized access.

Types of Data Processing Systems:

Types of data processing can be understood on basis of methods and technology adopted. Generally mechanical and electronic data processing is used and at times manual data processing is used. According to their working, Data processing systems can be of different types:

a) **Manual :** In manual data processing system, whole processing is done manually without use of machine or electronic device i.e. the clerical staff that perform data processing in an organized way with the goal of producing meaningful information. This method is slow and less reliable, chances of error are high and this method is very old when technical innovations were few and rare. This also makes processing expensive and requires large manpower depending on the data required to be processed. Data acquisition, filing, storage, processing, calculation, output production, all these tasks are done manually.

b) **Mechanical Data Processing:** Data processing is done by use of mechanical device or very simple electronic devices like calculator and typewriters. The advantage of this method is more reliability and saving of time as compared to manual data processing but still the output is limited. Any device which facilitates data processing can be considered under this category.



Fig.6.3. Mechanical Data Processing

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